1. Sickness and Absence Policy

The organization is committed to supporting employee health and wellbeing while ensuring operational continuity. Employees who are unable to attend work due to illness or injury must inform their line manager as soon as reasonably possible, preferably before the start of their working day.

Employees are required to provide accurate information regarding the nature and expected duration of their absence. For absences exceeding three consecutive working days, a self-certification form may be required. For absences longer than seven consecutive calendar days, a medical certificate issued by a qualified healthcare professional must be submitted to HR.

The organization reserves the right to review patterns of frequent or prolonged absence to identify potential underlying issues and to provide appropriate support. Where necessary, occupational health assessments may be arranged. Abuse of sickness absence provisions may result in disciplinary action.

2. Notice Period Policy

All employees are required to serve a notice period as outlined in their employment contract. The notice period applies equally whether the resignation is initiated by the employee or termination is initiated by the organization, subject to statutory requirements.

During the notice period, employees are expected to continue performing their duties to the same standard as prior to giving notice. The organization may, at its discretion, reduce or waive the notice period or place the employee on garden leave.

Failure to serve the required notice period without written agreement may result in deductions from final pay or other contractual remedies as permitted by law.

3. Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy

The Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) policy allows employees to use personal electronic devices, such as smartphones, tablets, or laptops, for work-related purposes, subject to approval and compliance with organizational security standards.

Employees must ensure that personal devices used for work have appropriate security measures in place, including password protection, encryption, and up-to-date software. The organization reserves the right to require installation of security software or to restrict access if devices do not meet security requirements.

Work-related data stored on personal devices remains the property of the organization. Upon termination of employment or upon request, employees must allow the removal of organizational data from personal devices.

4. Communications, Email, Internet and Social Media Policy

The organization provides communication tools including email, internet access, and internal messaging systems to support business operations. These tools must be used responsibly, professionally, and in accordance with company values.

Employees must not use company systems to transmit offensive, discriminatory, or inappropriate material. Limited personal use may be permitted provided it does not interfere with work responsibilities or violate any policies.

Social media activity that references the organization must be respectful and must not disclose confidential information. The organization reserves the right to monitor usage where legally permitted.

5. Alcohol Policy

The organization is committed to maintaining a safe and productive working environment. Employees must not consume alcohol during working hours, while on company premises, or while representing the organization at external events, unless expressly authorized.

Employees must report to work fit for duty and free from the effects of alcohol. Any behavior that compromises safety or performance due to alcohol consumption will be treated seriously and may result in disciplinary action.

Support will be offered to employees who voluntarily seek help for alcohol-related issues, subject to confidentiality and appropriate workplace accommodations.

6. Drugs Policy

The organization prohibits the use, possession, distribution, or sale of illegal drugs on company premises or while conducting company business. This includes misuse of prescription medication.

Employees must report to work in a condition that enables them to perform their duties safely and effectively. Any breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

The organization encourages employees to seek assistance for substance-related issues and will provide access to support resources where appropriate.

7. Retirement Policy

Employees may retire in accordance with statutory retirement regulations applicable in their jurisdiction. There is no compulsory retirement age unless mandated by law.

Employees considering retirement are encouraged to notify their manager and HR well in advance to allow for succession planning and knowledge transfer. Flexible or phased retirement arrangements may be considered where operationally feasible.

Retirement benefits will be administered in accordance with applicable pension schemes and legal requirements.

8. Redundancy Policy

Redundancy situations arise when roles are no longer required due to organizational changes, restructuring, or economic reasons. The organization is committed to managing redundancies fairly, transparently, and in compliance with legal obligations.

Employees affected by redundancy will be consulted and provided with clear information regarding the process, selection criteria, and timelines. Where possible, alternative employment within the organization will be explored.

Redundancy pay, notice, and support services will be provided in line with statutory and contractual entitlements.

9. Letter Placing an Employee on Garden Leave Following Resignation

Following receipt of an employee's resignation, the organization may place the employee on garden leave for all or part of the notice period. During garden leave, the employee remains employed and continues to receive salary and benefits but is not required to attend work.

Employees on garden leave must remain available during normal working hours and must not undertake other employment without written permission. Access to company systems may be restricted during this period.

Confidentiality and contractual obligations continue to apply throughout the garden leave period.

10. Employee Data Protection Policy (GDPR Compatible)

The organization is committed to protecting employee personal data in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and applicable data protection laws.

Employee data will be processed lawfully, fairly, and transparently, and only for legitimate business purposes. Access to personal data is restricted to authorized personnel.

Employees have the right to access, correct, and request deletion of their personal data, subject to legal limitations. Data breaches will be managed promptly and reported as required by law.

11. Home Working Policy

The organization supports flexible working arrangements, including home working, where appropriate. Home working must be approved by management and is subject to ongoing review.

Employees working from home are responsible for maintaining productivity, confidentiality, and data security. A suitable and safe working environment must be maintained.

The organization may require employees to attend the workplace as business needs dictate.

12. Employee Expenses Policy

Employees may claim reimbursement for reasonable and necessary business expenses incurred in the course of their duties, subject to prior approval where required.

All expense claims must be supported by valid receipts and submitted within the specified timeframe. Claims that do not comply with this policy may be rejected.

The organization reserves the right to audit expense claims and take action in cases of misuse.

13. Anti-Bribery Policy

The organization operates a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption. Employees must not offer, give, solicit, or accept bribes or improper advantages in any form.

This policy applies to all business dealings, including interactions with clients, suppliers, and public officials. Any suspected breach must be reported immediately.

Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action and potential legal consequences.

14. Probationary Period Policy

All new employees are subject to a probationary period as specified in their employment contract. The purpose of the probationary period is to assess performance, conduct, and suitability for the role.

During this period, performance will be reviewed regularly, and feedback will be provided. The organization may extend the probationary period where necessary.

Successful completion of probation will be confirmed in writing.

15. Induction Policy

The organization provides a structured induction program to ensure new employees are effectively integrated into the workplace.

The induction process includes an overview of company policies, procedures, values, and role-specific training. Line managers are responsible for ensuring completion of induction activities.

A well-managed induction supports employee engagement, productivity, and retention.

16. Recruitment Policy

The organization is committed to fair, transparent, and merit-based recruitment practices. All recruitment decisions are made based on skills, experience, and suitability for the role.

Vacancies will be advertised appropriately, and selection processes will be objective and consistent. The organization promotes equal opportunities and diversity.

All recruitment activities will comply with applicable employment laws and data protection requirements.